

NFL draft could draw 1M to D.C., leaders say

Goodell, Harris, Bowser join Trump to celebrate city hosting 2027 event

BY NICKI JHABVALA AND MARK MASKE

NFL Commissioner Roger Goodell, Washington Commanders owner Josh Harris and D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) gathered Monday for an official announcement that the NFL draft will be held in D.C. in the spring of 2027, an event they said could bring more than a million people to the National Mall and continue the resurgence of the city's pro football franchise.

What might have been a straightforward proclamation involving the NFL's top executive, a billionaire team owner and a triumphant politician, though, was hosted by President Donald Trump in the Oval Office, leaving Goodell, Harris and Bowser to wait through questions on movie tariffs, Trump's desire to reopen a federal penitentiary on Alcatraz and the reaction to an image posted on his Truth Social account of him dressed as the Pope.

Before and after those questions, Trump and the others celebrated news that reflected Bowser's view of her city as "a sports capital" and Trump's vision of the District as a staging ground for grand events, from a military parade commemorating the U.S. Army's 250th birthday to the biggest offseason event on the NFL's calendar.

"It's going to be beautiful," Trump said. "It's going to be something that nobody else will ever be able to duplicate, I don't suspect."

Harris said he believes hosting the 2027 NFL draft in D.C., along with his plans of building a new stadium on the site of dilapidated RFK Stadium, will not only boost the significance of football in the District but shatter attendance and viewership records for one of the league's annual tentpole events.

"I'm hoping we break 1 million in terms of the visitors," Harris

SEE DRAFT ON A7

Candace Buckner: In the Oval, NFL gifts Trump his hero shot. **D1**

A celebration of freedom



PETER DEJONG/AP

World War II veterans take part in a parade to mark Liberation Day in Wageningen, Netherlands, on Monday. The Nazi occupation of the country during the Second World War ended 80 years ago Monday, when it was liberated by Allied forces. The holiday is celebrated annually in the Netherlands with parades and music festivals.

Texas poised to increase control over universities

Outcome of bill could reverberate for higher education nationwide

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

A bruising battle over academic freedom is being waged in Texas, where the legislature is poised to give the state power to screen faculty, programs and courses in one of the country's largest public university systems, and experts say the outcome could reverberate for higher education nationwide.

Conservative lawmakers, who control all levers of the state gov-

ernment, are advancing a measure they say would hold institutions more accountable and ensure curriculum is "free from ideological bias." Faculty could be removed or face civil penalties for violations. Schools that do not comply could be barred from spending state funds.

"Higher education should be about teaching students how to think, not what to think," Lt. Gov. Dan Patrick (R) said.

The 27-page omnibus bill, which would rate academic programs based on average student debt and "return on investment for students," has already passed the state Senate. A House committee is expected to consider a version of S.B. 37 on Tuesday. If the

SEE TEXAS ON A4

A contracting economy squeezes U.S. housing

Tariffs make building more costly; mortgage rates likely to stay high

BY RACHEL SIEGEL

The faltering economy is starting to become a drag on the housing market.

Real estate agents, developers, home buyers and economists are all trying to make sense of which way trends are heading. Slower growth — the economy shrank at the beginning of 2025 — means interest and mortgage rates will probably stay high for the foreseeable future. Stock market swings

and flagging consumer confidence are pushing buyers out of the market. President Donald Trump's trade war is adding thousands to construction costs for new homes and remodels.

"Markets work because people have price knowledge, and they have those prices to make decisions," said Robert Dietz, chief economist at the National Association of Home Builders. But so much uncertainty, Dietz said, is creating a "wait-and-see economy."

A house is often a household's single largest investment or asset, and buying or selling can be one of

SEE HOUSING ON A15

'Dying' Hollywood: Trump calls for a tariff on foreign-made films. **C1**

Israel to seize parts of Gaza

CIVILIANS WOULD BE RELOCATED

Plan calls for aid hubs, indefinite military control

BY GERRY SHIH, KAREN DEYOUNG, LIOR SOROKA AND CLAIRE PARKER

JERUSALEM — Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Monday described "intensified" operations in Gaza, including a massive relocation of the Palestinian population and indefinite Israeli military "control" of large swaths of the enclave, setting a new direction in strategy and raising the question of whether Israel is inching toward the long-term reoccupation of the enclave.

The plan, unanimously approved in a meeting of Netanyahu's security cabinet Sunday night, will require tens of thousands of reservists to be called up in the coming weeks. Palestinian civilians living in areas of northern and southern Gaza would be displaced and confined within "sterile zones" secured by elements of the Israel Defense Forces, while other troops would continue efforts to root out Hamas fighters and destroy their tunnels.

The zones, under a separate cabinet decision, would include new "hubs," built by Israel and protected by U.S. security contractors, from which humanitarian aid would be distributed to Palestinians — though only those designated and vetted by Israel. Netanyahu's government has banned all humanitarian assistance from entering Gaza since it ended a brief ceasefire two months ago, leading to what the United Nations has called near-starvation conditions.

Israeli officials indicated that

SEE ISRAEL ON A12

Parting gift: Popemobile will now be a clinic for Gazan children. **A13**

Post wins Pulitzers for breaking news, cartoons

Top honors for reporting on assassination attempt, Telnaes's commentary

BY SCOTT NOVER

Jabin Botsford thought he was hearing fireworks until he saw Donald Trump fall. He immediately knew he needed to switch cameras — he was wielding his longer lens, but the once and future president of the United States had been shot just several feet in front of him, and the photographer was determined to get closer to the action.

"We all just reacted," Botsford recalled Monday. "I went forward. If this massively historic moment — maybe the most historic moment I will ever witness — is going to happen 10 feet in front of me, I'm going to get a good picture of it."

There are too many stories of photographers who miss important moments, he added, and "I didn't want to be one of them." He didn't even comprehend his own

SEE PULITZERS ON A8



JABI CHIKWENDIU/THE WASHINGTON POST

Photographer Jabin Botsford, right, and reporter Isaac Arnsdorf, seen Monday in the Post newsroom, covered the rally at which a would-be assassin fired at Donald Trump. | Pulitzer prizes for books, C3

OpenAI scraps plan to become for-profit firm

Elon Musk had criticized the restructuring move and sued to block it

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK

SAN FRANCISCO — ChatGPT maker OpenAI will remain under the control of its founding nonprofit board after abandoning a plan to split off its commercial operations as a for-profit company.

Former employees and Elon Musk, a co-founder of OpenAI who later split with its leaders, had criticized the restructuring plan, saying it would remove crucial oversight of its artificial intelligence technology. Musk filed a lawsuit seeking to block the move; the suit is ongoing.

OpenAI's new plan seeks a compromise between allegations that it was set to abandon its original mission of benefiting humanity and the claims of company leaders that it must raise more money and deliver profits to investors to com-

pete in the race to advance AI. The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.

It is unclear how the change will alter OpenAI's operations, but it offers a fillip to Musk, who has waged a public war against the company that he co-founded but now competes against with his AI venture, xAI. In addition to his lawsuit, the billionaire has publicly criticized OpenAI CEO Sam Altman. Musk's attorney did not respond to questions about whether the billionaire would drop the suit.

OpenAI's nonprofit board, pledged to ensure that supersmart AI benefits all of humanity, will now retain ultimate control of its operations. But the company will remove limitations it placed on the maximum returns investors could receive from investing in its for-profit arm. That division, which develops ChatGPT, will become a public benefit corporation, allowing it to seek profits while serving a particular mission.

In a call with reporters Monday, Altman said that once completed,

SEE OPENAI ON A18

IN THE NEWS

A little more time Dozens of pregnant USAID workers were given a layoff extension, allowing them to get benefits. **A6**

Minding its expenses Metro's expansion plans focus squarely on building out additional bus routes — not on expanding rail service. **B1**

THE NATION Chief of Staff Susie Wiles faces ethics questions as her former lobbying clients meet with White House staff. **A3**
The Trump administration offered migrants \$1,000 to self-deport. **A6**

THE WORLD Pope Francis created a more diverse set of cardinals, who will choose his successor. Also, a look at how the conclave, shrouded in secrecy, will select a new pontiff. **A9-10-11**

THE ECONOMY Companies courting President Donald Trump are playing up old plans as "America First" investments. **A17**
Warren Buffett's focus on building a business that thrives over the long term sets him apart, Bethany McLean writes. **A18**

THE REGION The District is moving to regulate cannabis dispensaries with greater oversight, and shops are already closing. **B1**
D.C. would repeal a law phasing out a lower minimum wage for tipped workers under a plan from Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D). **B1**

STYLE The National Endowment for the Arts rescinded grants for organizations nationwide. **C1**
HEALTH & SCIENCE After a diagnosis of cancer, a woman and her family find that photography helps them heal. **E1**

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